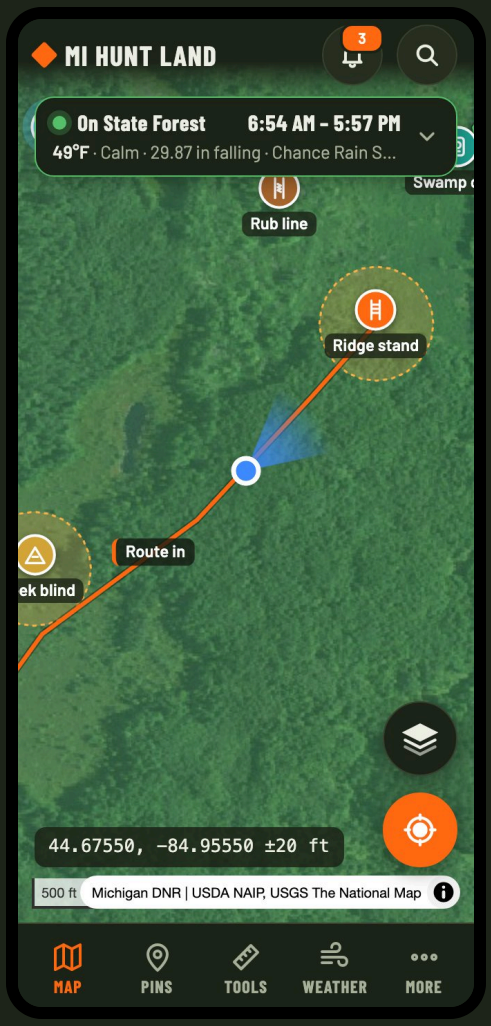
MI HUNT LAND

Field guide for hunters

Michigan public hunting land on your phone or computer, with hunting hours, wind, weather, your stands and hunt log, trail cam photos, and your hunting partners. Most of it keeps working with no cell signal.

hunt.tradersedges.net



Contents

1 **Getting started** — Sign in, the tabs and buttons — 3

2 **Put it on your home screen** — Open it like an app — 4

3 **Public land and map layers** — Land types, backgrounds, overlays — 5

4 **Forest cover types** — Show only the cover you want — 6

5 **Possibly landlocked public land** — Public land no road reaches — 6

6 **Logging on state land** — Recent cuts, active sales, planned cuts — 7

7 **3D view** — Tilt the map and see the hills — 8

8 **Hunting hours and the day's outlook** — Hours, weather, deer activity forecast, rut, moon — 9

9 **Pins and wind** — Stands, blinds, cams, sign, good winds — 10

10 **Hunt log and your patterns** — Sightings, sits, what works where — 11

11 **Trail cam photos** — Add, view, cam checks — 11

12 **Scent cones** — Where your scent is blowing — 12

13 **Go to** — Arrow and distance to any pin — 12

14 **Tracks** — Record your walk, find your way back — 13

15 **Lines and areas** — Property lines, routes, bedding, plots — 13

16 **Measure and safety zones** — Distance, acres, 450 ft rings — 14

17 **Weather radar** — Live rain and the last hour — 14

18 **Offline maps and search** — Before you lose signal — 15

19 **Hunting partners** — Share with everyone or just who you pick — 16

20 **Choosing which pins show** — By person, by type, copies hidden — 17

21 **Notifications** — The bell, alerts on your phone — 18

22 **Settings** — Text size, units, night mode, battery — 19

23 **On a computer** — Bigger map for planning, mouse and keys — 20

24 **Sync, backups and good to know** — Your data, limits, the rules — 21

1 Getting started

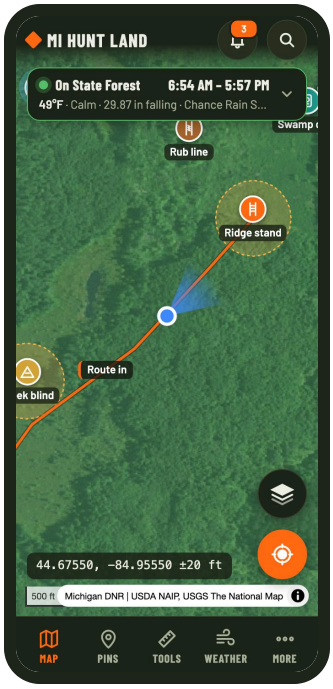
SIGN IN

1. Open **hunt.tradersedges.net** in Safari (iPhone), Chrome (Android) or any browser on a computer.
2. Enter your email. A one-time code is emailed to you; type it in. You stay signed in for a while, then it asks again.

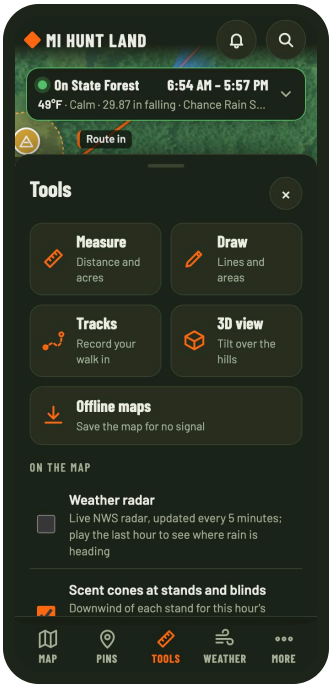
THE TABS AND BUTTONS

Top bar	Notifications (bell) · Search
Conditions strip	Under the top bar: the land you're on (*On State Forest*, *Not on mapped public land*…), today's legal hours and the weather. Tap it for the full outlook. After legal light ends, it shows tomorrow.
Tabs	Along the bottom: **Map** (closes any panel) · **Pins** · **Tools** (measure, draw, tracks, 3D, offline maps, radar, scent cones) · **Weather** · **More** (hunting partners, settings, backup)
Right side	Layers · My location (orange)
Blue dot	You. The cone shows which way you're facing.

> **Tip:** press and hold anywhere on the map to drop a pin there (right-click on a computer). Tap any land to see what it is.



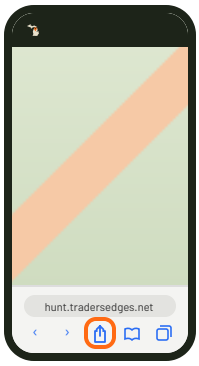
The map: conditions strip on top, tabs along the bottom



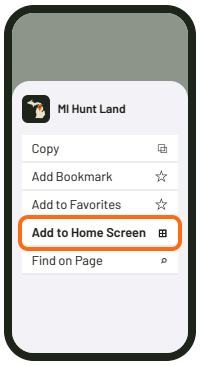
The Tools tab

2 Put it on your home screen

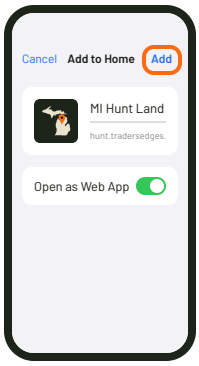
Android: tap the ⋮ menu, then **Install app** or **Add to Home screen**. **iPhone:** step by step below. It then opens full screen like an app, works offline once it has loaded with a signal, and can show alerts.



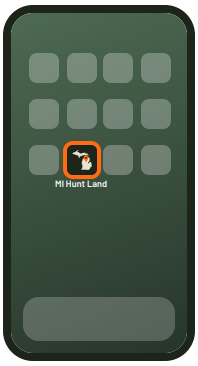
1 In **Safari**, open **hunt.tradersedges.net** and tap **Share**. No Share button? Tap ••• first.



2 Scroll down and tap **Add to Home Screen**. Not listed? Tap **View More**.



3 Keep the name and leave **Open as Web App** on. Tap **Add**.



4 Open it from the **Michigan icon** from now on: full screen, with no Safari bars.

> **Have the old orange-diamond icon?** Press and hold it, delete it, then add the app again as above. Your pins, logs and photos are safe on the server; just sign in again with an email code.

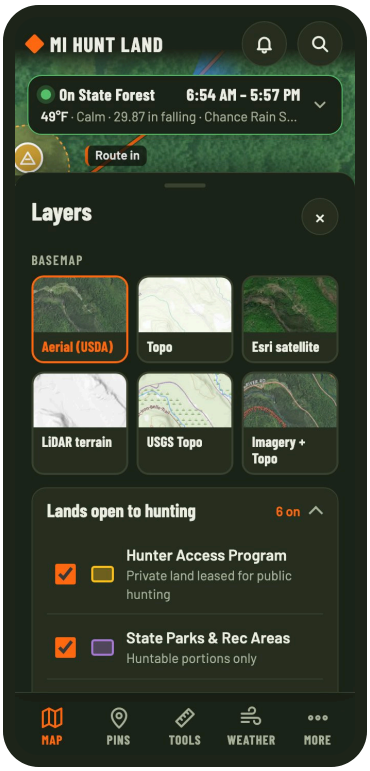
3 Public land and map layers

Tap Layers (right side, above the orange location button) to choose what shows. Pick a background from the pictures at the top; the land types and the overlays are in groups you can open and close, each showing how many layers are on.

LANDS OPEN TO HUNTING

State Forest	DNR state forest land
Game areas	State game and wildlife areas
State parks	Only the parts open to hunting
National Forest	Huron-Manistee, Hiawatha, Ottawa
Commercial Forest	Private land open on foot for hunting
HAP	Private land leased for public hunting; check-in rules apply

Land boundaries are stored on your phone, so they work with no signal. Tap any parcel for its name and details. **3D view** under Tools tilts the map to show the hills.



Layers: backgrounds, then land types and overlays

BACKGROUNDS

Aerial (USDA) (the default: recent summer aerial photos, about 2 ft detail; zoomed in close it takes a few seconds to sharpen), **Topo**, **Esri satellite** (older photos, often with the leaves down), **LiDAR terrain** (bare-earth shading that shows ridges, benches, draws and creek beds through the trees), **USGS Topo** and **Imagery + Topo**.

OVERLAYS

- **Forest stand cover type**: aspen, oak, pine, swamp conifer and more (zoom in).
- **Logging on state land**: recent cuts, active timber sales and planned cuts (zoom in).
- **DNR roads** (with ORV status), **DNR trails** (including hunter walking trails), **DNR parking**.
- **Sections and townships**, **Deer management units**.
- **Private land owners**: owner names and acres (Kalamazoo County).
- **Possibly landlocked public land**, covered later in this guide.

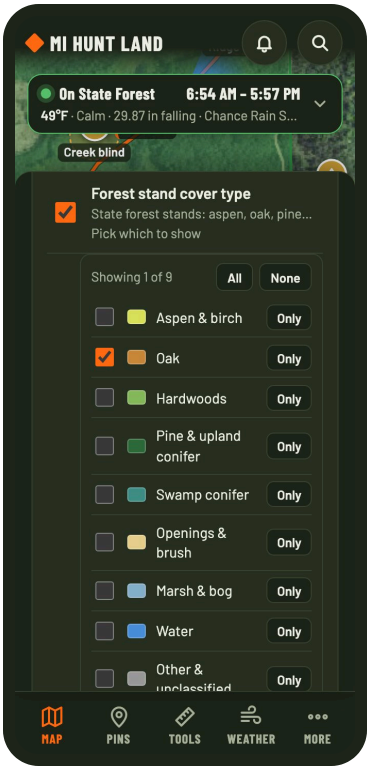
Overlays load from the DNR as you move, so they need a signal. **Weather radar** and **Scent cones** are switched on under Tools.

4 Forest cover types

With **Forest stand cover type** on, a list of cover types opens under it, each with its map color: aspen & birch, oak, hardwoods, pine & upland conifer, swamp conifer, openings & brush, marsh & bog, water, and other.

- Untick any type to hide it.
- **Only** shows just that type. For example, tap **Only** next to Oak to see where the oak stands are.
- **All** and **None** reset the list. Your choice is remembered.

Tap a stand for its cover type, size class, age and canopy.



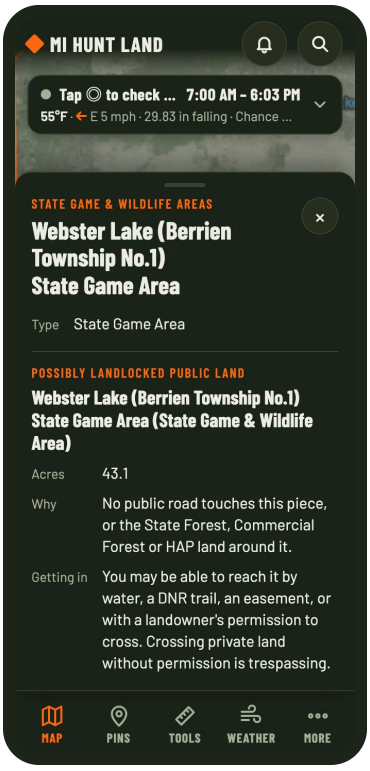
Only oak stands showing

5 Possibly landlocked public land

Turn it on in Layers. Red pieces are public land that **no public road touches**, not even through neighbouring State Forest, Commercial Forest or HAP land. Pieces like these often see less pressure.

Tap one for its name, acres and how you might get in.

> **Getting in legally:** you may reach it by water, a DNR trail, a forest road, an easement, or with a landowner's permission to cross. Crossing private land without permission is trespassing.



43 acres on Webster Lake, Berrien County

6 Logging on state land

Three overlays in Layers (open **Logging, forest cover and more**), under **Logging on state land**. Zoom in to see them.

RECENT CUTS

State forest stands that started growing back in the last 10 years, usually after a harvest. They're shaded by age:

0–2 years	Fresh cut: slash, stumps, new sprouts
3–5 years	Thick regrowth, peak browse
6–10 years	Dense cover; good bedding

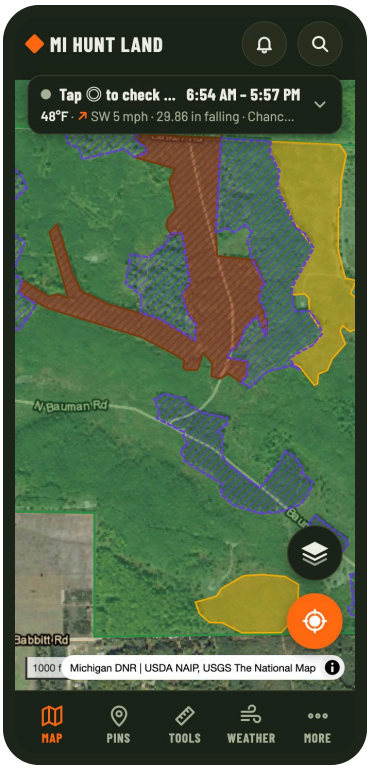
ACTIVE TIMBER SALES

Brown stripes. The DNR has sold or laid out these areas, so they're being logged or will be soon. Expect crews, trucks and new skid trails, and check before you hang a stand.

PLANNED CUTS

Purple stripes with a dashed edge. These are harvests the DNR has proposed for coming years. Tap one for the kind of cut (clearcut, thinning, selection…), the earliest start, and the forester's own plan for the stand.

> **Good to know:** this covers land the DNR manages (State Forest, game areas, and some National Forest sales it runs). Logging on Commercial Forest and HAP land is done by private owners and isn't shown. Planned cuts can change: the DNR takes public comments on each forest compartment before approving them.



Recent cuts, an active sale and planned cuts

7 3D view

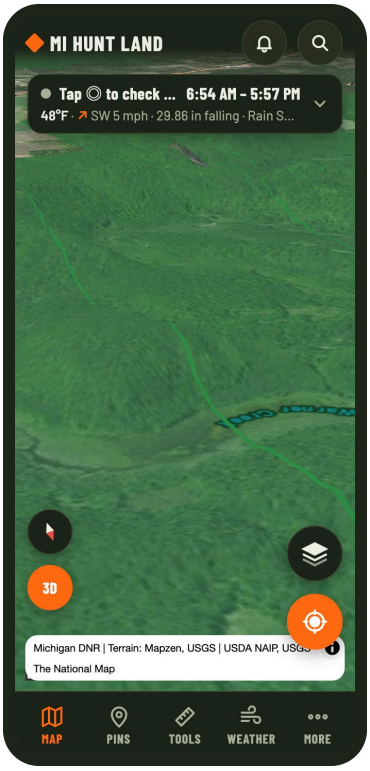
Open **Tools** and tap **3D view**. The map tilts and the land rises, so ridges, benches, saddles and creek bottoms stand out. Land boundaries, pins, tracks and overlays all lie on the ground.

- **Tilt:** drag two fingers up or down.
- **Turn:** twist two fingers. A compass button appears bottom left, above the orange **3D** button; tap it to point north again.
- **On a computer:** use the arrow buttons that appear above **3D** (up and down tilt, the curved arrows turn), or hold the right mouse button and drag.
- Tap the orange **3D** button (bottom left, only there while 3D is on) to go back to a flat, north-up map.

Aerial (USDA) in 3D is the best way to read a funnel or a bedding bench before you walk in.

3D hills under Tools sets how much the hills are raised: **Low**, **Medium** (the default) or **High**. Michigan's ground is gentle, so a little lift makes ridges and draws easier to read.

> **Good to know:** 3D needs a signal for the elevation data and uses more battery, so it stays off until you turn it on. Saving an offline area while tilted saves what's around the middle of the screen, not out to the horizon.



The Jordan River Valley in 3D on Aerial (USDA)

8 Hunting hours and the day's outlook

The conditions strip at the top always shows the land you're on, legal hours for where you are (or the middle of the map) and the weather. Tap it, or the **Weather** tab, for the full picture.

THE CONDITIONS STRIP

- The land under you (green edge on public land, red off it), then opens – closes.
- Underneath: how long is left and sunrise (until the sun is up) or sunset.
- Temperature, wind (the arrow points where it's blowing), pressure and its trend, and the sky.
- **After legal light ends** it switches to tomorrow: tomorrow's hours, the time until opening, sunrise, and the forecast for first light.

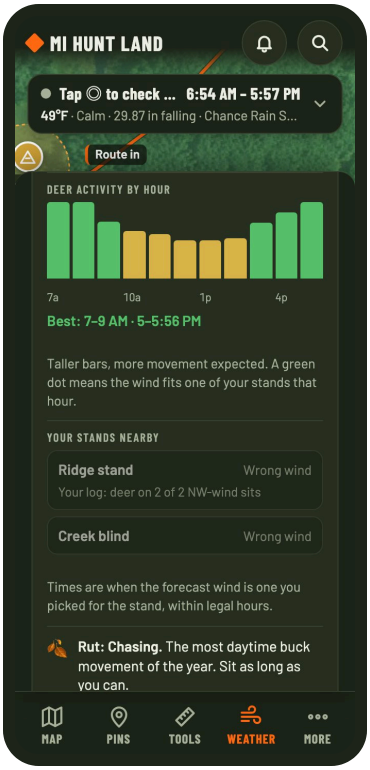
WIND FOR THE NEXT 12 HOURS, THEN "AT A GLANCE"

- **Deer activity, 1 to 5:** Great, Good, Fair or Slow day, with the reasons. The rut, a cold snap, a pressure change and your stands getting their wind count for it; strong wind, likely rain and heat count against.
- **Right now:** temperature, sky, wind, pressure, rain chance.
- **Outlook:** high and low, cold snap flag, what the pressure does, and conditions at first light and in the last hour.
- **Deer activity by hour:** bars for each hour of legal light, tallest around first and last light, higher at midday in the rut, lower in windy, wet or warm hours. **Best** lists the top stretches; a green dot means one of your stands has its wind that hour.
- **Your stands nearby:** the times each stand's wind is right, and what your log says works there.
- **Rut:** where the rut usually is on that date in Michigan (pre-rut, seeking, chasing, peak breeding, post-rut, second rut) and what it means.
- Sunrise and sunset, moon phase, and which deer seasons are open.

BELOW THAT

- **Next 7 days:** tap a day to plan it. The five small bars are that day's activity score. ▼**8°** marks a cold snap; arrows show pressure (↓↑ is a front passing).
- **More detail:** the hours table (with sunrise and sunset), forecast wording, what the pressure means for deer, moon times, solunar periods, and the rules: seasons, antler restrictions, antlerless licenses, baiting.

> **It learns from you:** once your pins have 8 sits logged (log "No deer" too), the forecast leans toward the temperatures, pressure and time of day you've actually seen deer in. The moon is left out: GPS-collar studies found it makes little difference, while the rut and temperature drops matter most.



Deer activity by hour for tomorrow, with the best times

9 Pins and wind

DROP A PIN

- Press and hold on the map (right-click on a computer), or open the **Pins** tab and tap **+ Pin where I am** or **+ Pin map center**.
- Pick a type: tree stand, ground blind, camp, trail cam, buck rub, buck scrape, parking or other.
- Add a name and notes (access route, shooting lanes).

GOOD WINDS

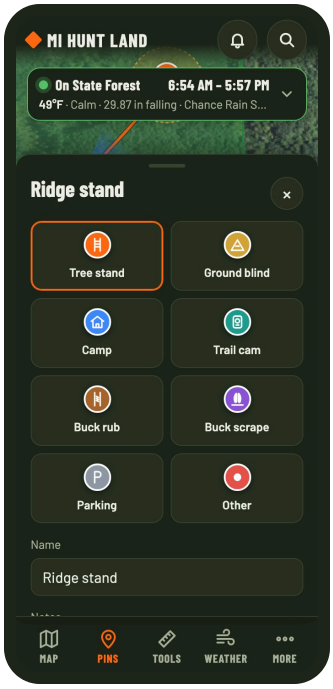
For stands and blinds, tick the winds the spot hunts well in (where the wind comes from). The pin then shows:

- Whether **right now** is a good wind, and the good-wind stretches in legal hours over the next days.
- A **Good wind / Wrong wind** badge in your pin list.
- Its good-wind times in the day's outlook, and in an evening notification for tomorrow.

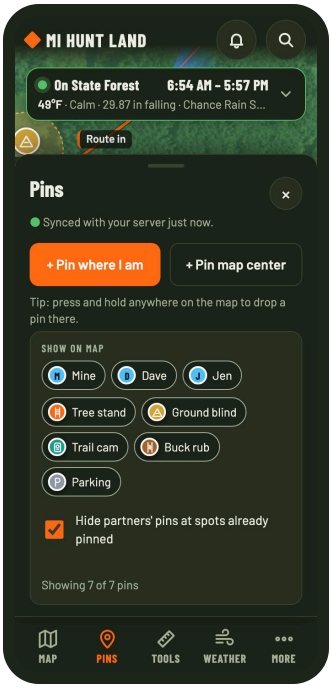
FROM A PIN

Go to	Arrow and distance on foot
Drive	Driving directions in Google Maps
Share	A link anyone can open: spot, name and type only

The **Pins** tab lists everything by distance from you, with each stand's wind badge, then your lines and areas. The wind for your area is on the **Weather** tab.



A stand: type, name, notes



The Pins tab

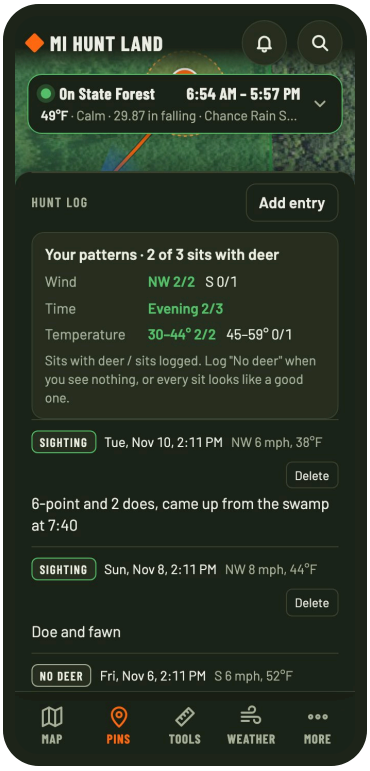
10 Hunt log and your patterns

Open a pin and tap **Add entry** after each sit:

- **Sighting**, **Shot**, **Harvest**, **No deer** or **Note**, plus what happened.
- The time and the weather (wind, temperature, pressure) fill in by themselves.

After **3 sits** at a spot, **Your patterns** shows what worked: sits with deer out of sits logged, by wind, morning or evening, temperature and pressure trend. The best one is in green.

> **Log the empty sits too.** Tap **No deer** when nothing shows, or every sit looks like a good one.



Patterns: NW wind 3 for 3

11 Trail cam photos

- Open a pin (usually a trail cam) and tap **Add photos**. Pick from your camera roll or Files; a whole card's worth at once is fine.
- Each photo shows the time the **camera** took it, not when you uploaded it.
- Your phone shrinks photos before uploading, so a big trail cam picture becomes about half a megabyte.
- On a trail cam pin, adding photos logs a **Cam check**; the pin list shows "Checked 3 days ago · 24 photos".
- Tap a photo for full screen: add a note ("8-point, from the swamp"), step through newer and older (arrow keys on a computer), or delete.

Uploading needs a signal. A photo you've opened once is kept for offline viewing.

12 Scent cones

Scent cones are on to start; switch them off or on under **Tools**. Each tree stand and ground blind gets a wedge showing where your scent drifts for this hour's forecast wind, about 300 m downwind. In calm air it's a circle around the stand.

The cone turns red when it covers one of your trail cams, rubs or scrapes, and the pin list warns you ("Scent over Rub line now").



Scent cones on a SW wind

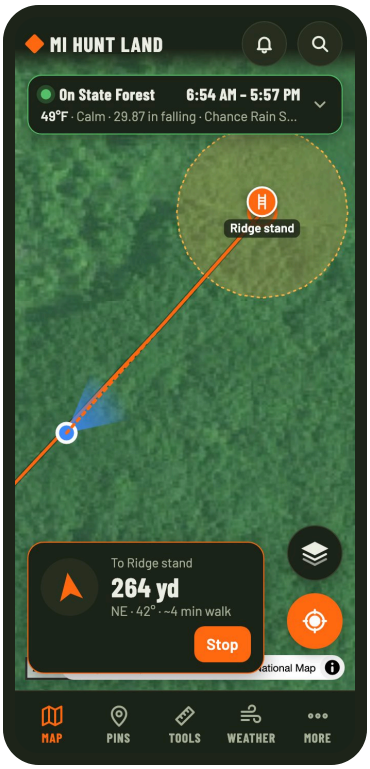
13 Go to

Open any pin (yours or a partner's) and tap **Go to**. You get:

- A big arrow pointing the way, the distance, compass heading and walking time.
- A dashed line on the map from you to it.
- A buzz when you're within about 15 yards.

The first time, your iPhone asks to use the compass. Allow it (the same compass turns the cone on your blue dot), or tap **Compass** later. Until it has the compass, the arrow points against map north ("arrow is map-up"); once you're walking it uses your direction of travel.

> **Works with no signal.** GPS and the compass don't need cell service. Tap **Stop** when you're there.



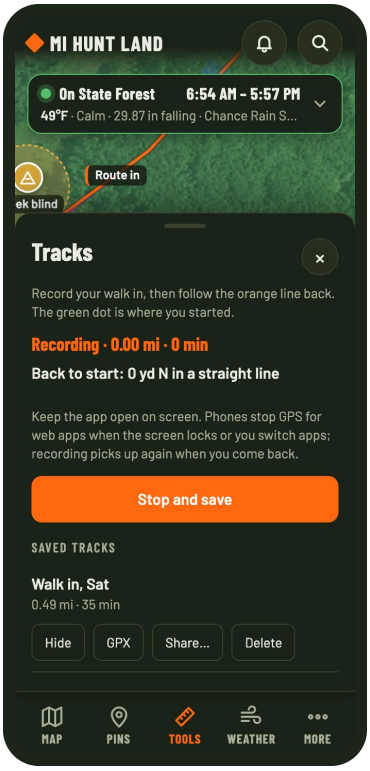
Going to Ridge stand

14 Tracks

Open **Tools**, tap **Tracks**, then **Start recording** as you walk in. The orange line follows you, the green dot is where you started, and a dotted line points straight back to it with the distance.

Stop and save when you're done. Saved tracks can be shown or hidden on the map, saved as GPX, shared with partners, or deleted.

> **Keep the app open on screen while recording.** Phones stop GPS for web apps when the screen locks or you switch apps; recording picks up again when you come back. Turn on **Keep the screen on** in Settings for long walks.

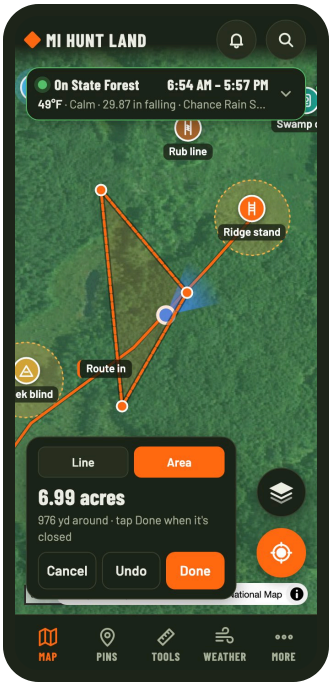


Recording, with the walk in from parking

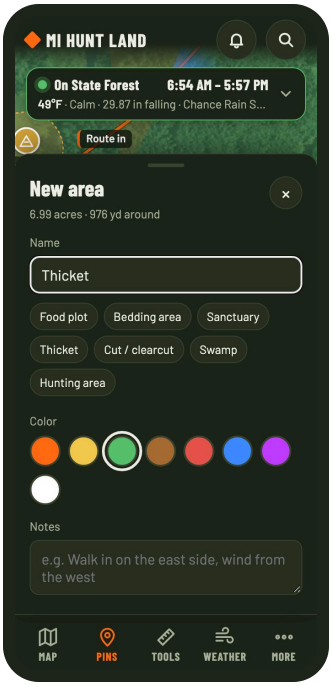
15 Lines and areas

1. Open **Tools** and tap **Draw** (or **Draw** under Lines and areas in the Pins tab).
2. Pick **Line** (property line, route in, drag line, shooting lane) or **Area** (food plot, bedding area, sanctuary, thicket).
3. Tap points on the map. The length or acres show as you go; **Undo** removes the last point.
4. Tap **Done**, then name it (or tap a suggestion), pick a color, add notes, and **Save**.

Tap a line or area later to rename it, **Change points**, or delete it. They're listed in the Pins tab.



Drawing an area



Naming it

16 Measure and safety zones

Open **Tools** and tap **Measure**.

- **Distance / area:** tap points for the distance; three or more points also give the acres inside. Tap a pin to measure to it exactly.
- **450 ft ring:** tap a house or farm building to draw Michigan's safety zone. No hunting inside it, gun or bow, without written permission from the owner or occupant.

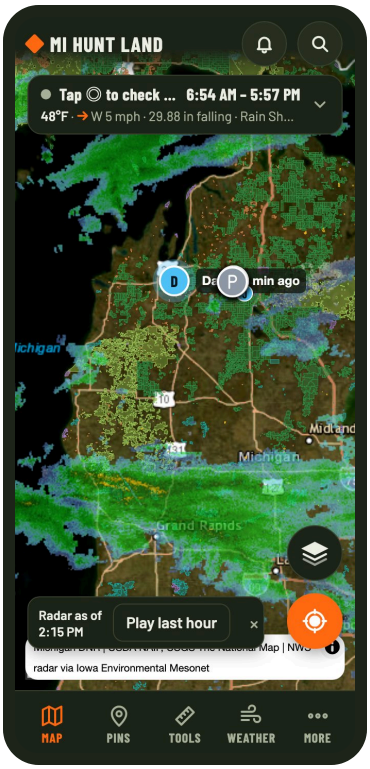


352 yd, 3.12 acres

17 Weather radar

Turn on **Weather radar** under Tools to see live rain from the National Weather Service, updated every 5 minutes. The bar at the bottom shows the time of the latest scan.

Tap **Play last hour** to loop the last 50 minutes and see which way the rain is moving. Tap × to turn radar off. Radar needs a signal.



A storm line moving through

18 Offline maps and search

OFFLINE MAPS

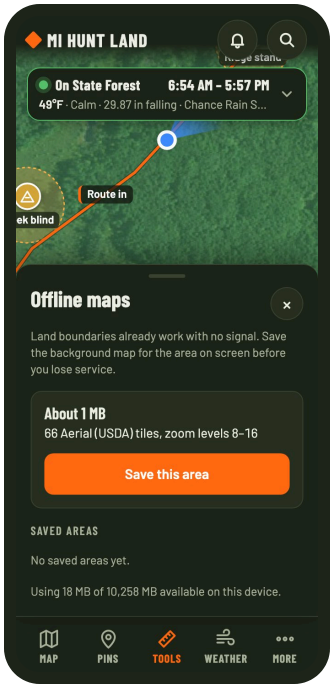
Land boundaries, your pins, the hours and the moon always work offline. The **background map** needs saving first:

1. With a signal, move the map over where you'll hunt.
2. Open **Tools**, tap **Offline maps**, check the size, and tap **Save this area**.

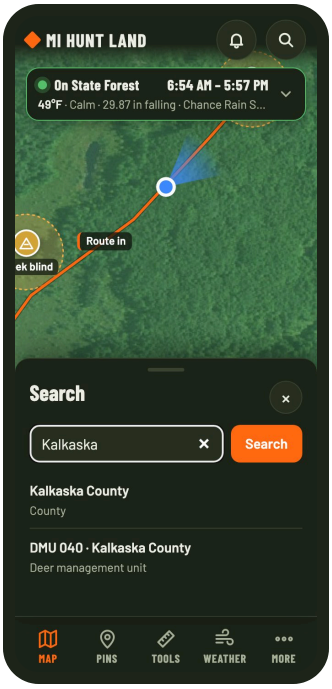
Save each background you want (Aerial, Topo, Esri satellite, LiDAR) separately. Saved areas show as dashed outlines.

SEARCH

Tap the magnifier at the top and search for a game area, town, your pins, a county, a DMU, a township and section (`T29N R2W S23`) or coordinates.



Save this area



Search

19 Hunting partners

If you're part of a hunting group, you can share the spots you choose, with the whole group or only certain people, and see each other on the map. Nothing is shared unless you tick it.

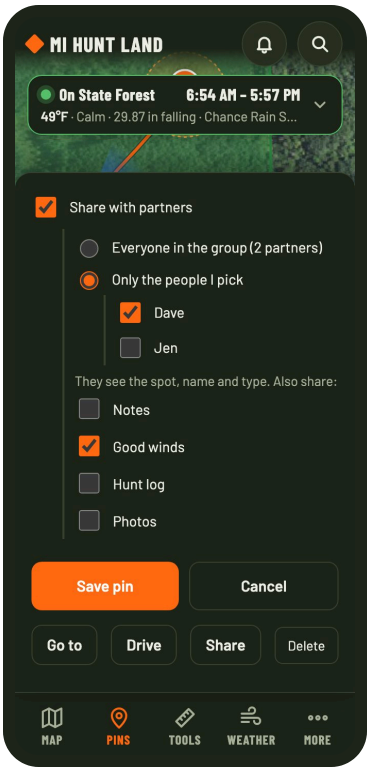
SHARE A PIN, LINE OR AREA

1. Open it and tick **Share with partners**.
2. Choose who: **Everyone in the group** (including anyone who joins later), or **Only the people I pick** and tick their names.
3. That shares the spot, name and type. Tick anything else you want them to see: **Notes**, **Good winds**, **Hunt log**, **Photos**. Each is off until you turn it on.

Tracks have a **Share…** button in the Tracks list with the same choices. Your lists show who each thing is shared with. Untick something, or untick a person, and it disappears from their map.

WHAT PARTNERS SEE

- Only what you shared with them, with your initial on it. Lines, areas and tracks show dashed. They can look, and use Go to, but can't change anything.
- Only the extras you ticked. They never see who else you shared something with.
- They get a notification when you share something new with them.



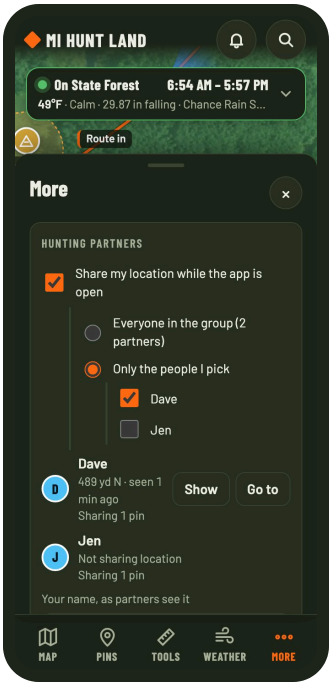
Ridge stand, shared only with Dave, with its good winds

WHERE EVERYONE IS

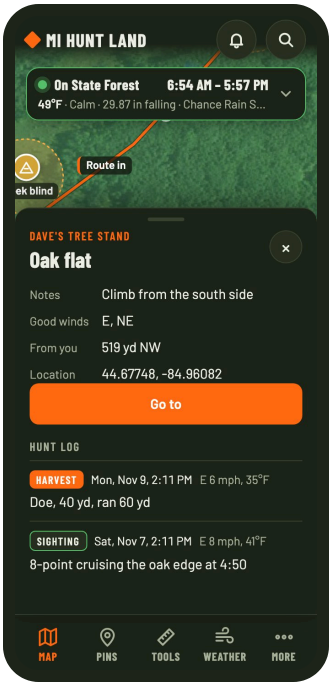
In the **More** tab, under Hunting partners, tick **Share my location**, then choose everyone or only certain people. They see you as a blue dot with your initial and "seen 3 min ago", and the list shows how far away and which direction each partner is, with **Show** and **Go to**.

> **Your phone only sends your location while the app is open on screen.** With the phone locked or another app in front, partners see your last spot and how long ago it was. Set the name partners see you as in the same place.

To join a group, ask the group owner to add your email.



Location shared only with Dave



What a partner sees: the stand and the log you shared

20 Choosing which pins show

Once partners share, the map can get busy, and two of you may have pinned the same stand. **Show on map**, in the Pins tab, sorts that out. It only changes what's drawn on the map; nothing is deleted or unshared.

BY PERSON

Tap **Mine** or a partner's name to hide or show their pins. A partner's shared tracks, lines and areas hide with them.

BY TYPE

Tap a type, such as **Parking** or **Trail cam**, to hide every pin of that type, yours and partners'. Only types someone has used are listed.

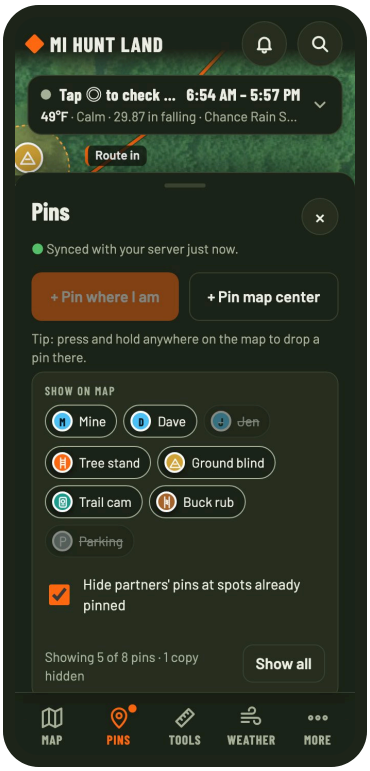
COPIES OF THE SAME SPOT

Hide partners' pins at spots already pinned is on to start. A partner's pin that's the same type within about 30 m (100 ft) of one already showing, or any pin within 10 m, is hidden, and your pin gets their initial on it instead. If you hide your own pins, theirs show again.

KNOWING WHAT'S HIDDEN

- Hidden chips are dimmed and crossed out, and the line underneath says how many pins are showing and how many copies are hidden.
- While anything is hidden, the **Pins** tab has an orange dot. **Show all** brings everything back.
- Your pins that are hidden still appear in the list, dimmed. Scent cones only show for pins on the map.

> The phone remembers your choices, so they stay the same next time you open the app.



Jen's pins and parking hidden; Dave's copy of Ridge stand is hidden too

21 Notifications

The **bell** at the top shows how many notifications you haven't seen. Tap it for the list; tap one with a place to fly the map there.

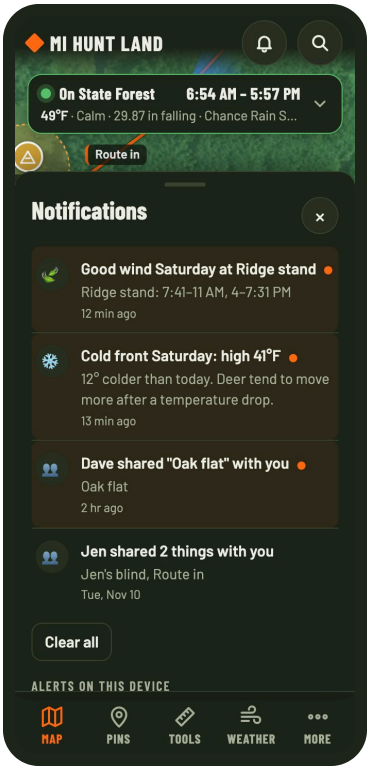
- **A partner shared something** with you.
- **Good wind tomorrow:** each evening, the times tomorrow when your stands' good winds line up with legal hours.
- **Cold front:** each evening, when tomorrow's high is 8°F or more below today's.

Under **Notify me when**, untick any kind you don't want.

ALERTS ON YOUR PHONE

Tap **Turn on alerts** in the bell panel and allow notifications, once on each phone or computer. You then get an alert even when the app is closed. **Send a test** checks it works.

> **iPhone:** alerts only work in the app opened from your Home Screen (see Getting started), not in Safari.



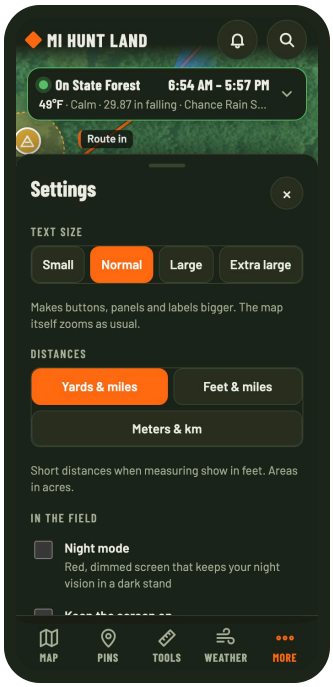
Tomorrow's good wind, a cold front and partner shares

22 Settings

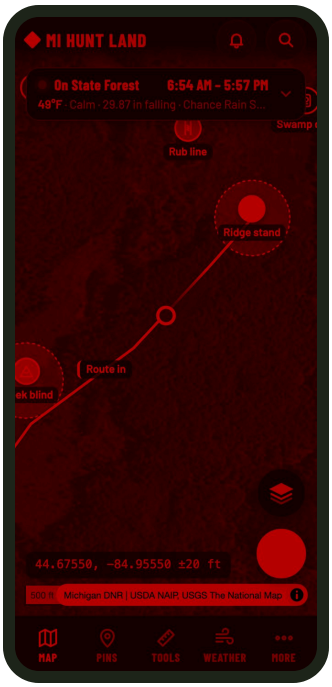
Open the **More** tab and tap **Settings**.

Text size	Small, Normal, Large or Extra large. Makes buttons, panels and labels bigger; the map itself still zooms as usual.
Distances	Yards & miles, Feet & miles, or Meters & km. Areas show in acres, or hectares with meters.
Night mode	Turns the whole screen red and dim, like a red headlamp, so you keep your night vision in a dark stand.
Keep the screen on	Stops the screen sleeping while the app is open. Handy with Go to and tracks; uses more battery.
Battery saver	Checks GPS once a minute instead of constantly, and shares your location with partners every 2 minutes. Recording a track and Go to still get full-speed GPS.
Names on the map	Show or hide the labels under pins, lines and areas. Pin and line names also hide by themselves when you zoom out far, where they'd pile up.
Walking pace	Slow (1.5 mph), Normal (2 mph) or Fast (3 mph), for Go to's walking time.
About	This guide, **Check for update**, and a line of screen sizes that helps sort out layout trouble on a phone.

Settings are saved on each phone or computer separately.



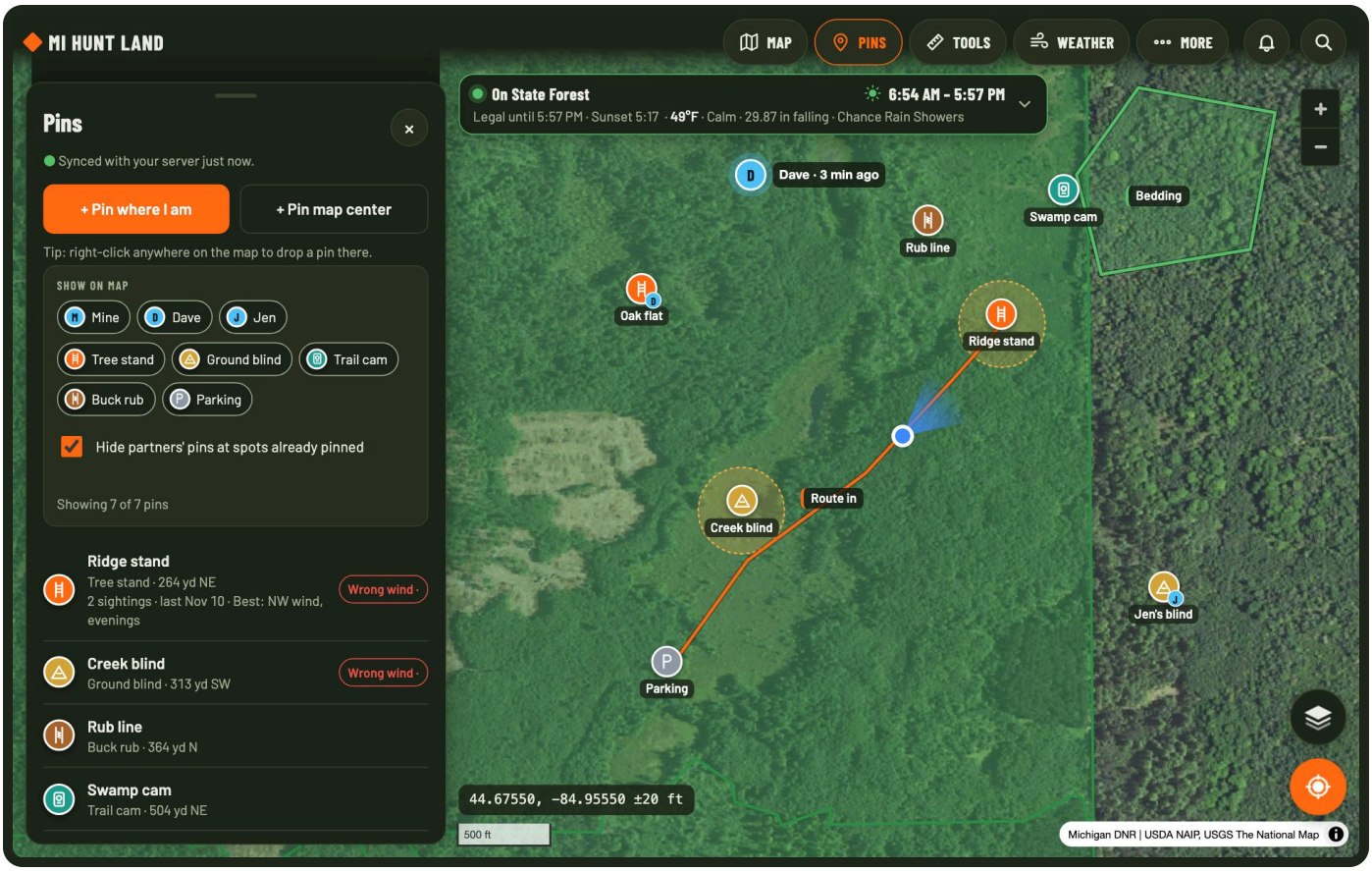
Settings



Night mode

23 On a computer

Open hunt.tradersedges.net in any browser and sign in the same way. Everything syncs, so plan at home and it's on your phone in the woods.



Planning on a computer: the Pins tab in the side panel, with partners and their shared spots on the map

WHAT'S DIFFERENT

Tabs	Map, Pins, Tools, Weather and More sit along the top, beside the bell and search.
Panels	Open down the left side, and the map moves over so nothing is hidden.
Drop a pin	Right-click anywhere on the map.
Zoom	Scroll wheel or trackpad, or the + and – buttons at the top right.
3D	With **3D view** on (Tools), arrow buttons above the **3D** button bottom left tilt and turn the map, or hold the right mouse button and drag.
Coordinates	The bottom corner shows the latitude and longitude under your mouse.
Keys	`Esc` closes the open panel. `/` or `Ctrl` + `K` (`⌘` + `K` on a Mac) opens search. `←` `→` step through photos.

24 Sync, backups and good to know

YOUR DATA

- Pins, hunt logs, photos, tracks, lines and areas are saved on your phone **and** on the private server. Changes sync whenever you have a signal; the top of the Pins tab says when it last synced.
- Sign in on another phone, tablet or computer and everything is there.
- The server is backed up every night. You can also save your own copy: the **More** tab, then **Full backup**. **Import** brings a backup or GPX file back in, and **Pins as GPX** opens in onX, HuntStand, Gaia and Google Earth.

GOOD TO KNOW

- **GPS only runs while the app is open on screen.** This is true for every web app on a phone. On long sits, turn on **Battery saver** in Settings.
- Weather, radar, overlays, notifications and photo uploads need a signal. Land boundaries, pins, hours, the moon, Go to and saved offline maps don't.
- If the app says you're signed out, reload it and enter a new email code.
- When an update comes out, the app reloads itself once. Settings, then **Check for update**, does it right away. This guide is updated with each new feature.

> **This map is a guide, not a legal boundary.** It doesn't show safety zones around buildings (use the 450 ft ring), posted closures, refuges inside open areas, or local ordinances. The hours and rules summarise the 2026 Michigan Deer Hunting Digest. Always check the full digest and Michigan.gov/DNRLaws before you hunt.